

101 reasons to switch to Mozilla

Word on the street is that there are 101 things that Mozilla can do that Internet Explorer 6 cannot. The list that has been filtering through programmer news-groups and discussion forums was created by Neal Deakin, a 28-year-old resident of Toronto, Canada. Popular with the open source



community, Mozilla is a standalone open source browser created by Mozilla.org. Deakin though cautions against reading too much into his list—quite a few of the items on the list are long time grouses against Internet Explorer, such as the lack of being able to navigate through

multiple windows through tabs and the inability to block popup ads. Other grievances include the lack of people-friendly tools such as the ability to zoom text, save plugins while saving a Web page, adding detailed information about bookmarks and the ability to block images from third-party sites. There is also additional mention of user-friendly cookie management, easy password management, form filling, better security and the claim of being able to run straight off a CD or a network.

redalert

Roron

A new worm called Roron or Oror.B could help hackers control home computers. It can spread through e-mail, shared drives and the KaZaA network. Each copy of the virus contains several hacker tools that let an infected computer be controlled by messages from Internet Relay Chat (IRC). Once Roron infects a system, it spreads by creating e-mail messages with different subject lines and names for the attached file. Once opened, Roron copies itself to several folders, including those used to share files on the KaZaA network, as well as to any shared hard drives on a network. Finally, Roron installs a backdoor into the PC that lets remote attackers run attack tools. Though Kapersky Labs attaches high risk to the virus, Symantec rates Roron as only two on its threat scale of five. Updating your anti-virus software should take care of the virus.

Philips joins the DVD format war

Early in November 2002, Philips Electronics announced that it has developed a new DVD Writer in an effort to promote the DVD+RW format. Philips debuted the main meat of a proposed DVD+RW drive that has an integrated chipset, optical pickup unit and a reference design. The drive claims to record at



speeds of up to 8x. Philips holds the key patents and stands to obtain significant revenues from licensing, should DVD+RW become a dominant format in the near future. The company will license and sell components for the drives and hopes to see manufacturers making them available in the first half of 2003.

Mac-ing it easy

If you are a PC user moving towards a Mac, this is just the software and hardware combination that could ease the transition. Move 2 Mac comes with a lot of software and a customised USB cable that lets PC users move many of their files and settings into a Macintosh running the new OS X. The software will also let you keep your background pictures, by transferring them onto the Mac.



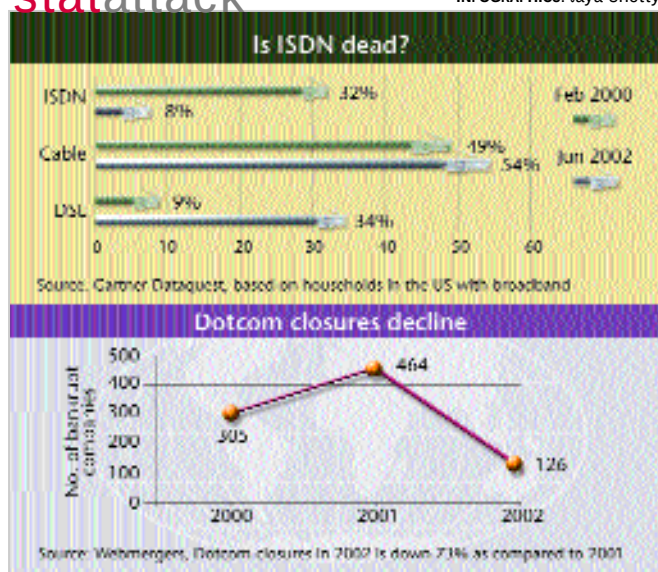
Detto Technologies, the developers of this software, reportedly received no funding from Apple, though Apple intends to carry it into their retail store. Apart from Internet settings, files and contacts, the other things such as pictures and music are automatically moved into the right location on the new Mac, without much tinkering. With Apple's new campaign focussing on luring PC users to the Mac platform, it appears that the scales may just have been tilted!

Fishy on Linux

Backdoor.Bofishy.C is a Trojan that affects the libpcap packet capture library and the tcpdump sniffer on Unix and Linux systems. It comes as modified source packages that create a backdoor during their installation that gives the attacker access to a shell on the local computer. Users and administrators are advised to turn off unnecessary services, patch all running software with the latest updates, especially Internet services and configure e-mail servers to block or remove e-mail that contains file attachments that are commonly used to spread viruses, such as vbs, bat, exe, pif and scr files.

statattack

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